

NISCHAL DAVE

Category Manager | Category & Brand Management | Consumer Insights & Analytics | Product & Project Management |
\$5M+ Impact
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nisch07.github.io/nischal_dave_portfolio

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Category Manager with 6+ years across category management, brand management, consumer insights, and product and project delivery. Owns Annual Operating Plan (AOP) strategy and execution for a \$45M home decor business at Lowe's (~500K SKUs, US & Canada e-commerce), managing national and private-label brand partnerships and the full mix of growth levers, search, price, fulfillment, content, stock, marketplace, and assortment. Turns customer and business data into prioritized initiatives, from a Gen Z segment discovery that drove \$420K in incremental revenue to a \$5M vendor findability fix, and builds them into business cases taken through launch and rollout. Partners cross-functionally to execute, and mentors and onboards new team members on category reporting and execution.

CORE SKILLS

Category Management (AOP & Assortment Strategy) | Brand Management (National & Private Label Partnerships) | Consumer Insights & Data-Driven Segmentation | Product Management (Business Case Development & Launch) | Project & Cross-Functional Program Management | Risk & Business Continuity Planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lowe's

Bengaluru, India

Category Manager | April 2022 - July 2026

- Owned Annual Operating Plan (AOP) strategy and execution for a \$45M home decor business (~500K SKUs, US & Canada e-commerce), managing revenue, returns, and the full mix of growth levers, search, price, fulfillment, content, stock, marketplace, and assortment, against target.
- Managed national and private-label brand partnerships across 1P, 2P, and 3P marketplace models, including transitioning vendor partner Safavieh to a 3P model and working with Private Brand Advocates to drive Lowe's Private Brands, as part of category strategy.
- Used BazaarVoice review data and SQL-based segmentation to identify a fast-growing Gen Z consumer segment, partnered with the content team to launch GIF-based visual merchandising on product detail pages, and generated \$420K in incremental revenue and +20 bps increase in PDP CVR (A/B tested).
- Built the business case for Rugs Visualiser, a \$1.4M feature opportunity surfaced through customer behavior analysis, partnered with the Tech team to launch it, and owned experimentation through rollout.
- Spotted a search and findability gap limiting premium brand visibility, onboarded vendor partner Ruggable, and executed a fix with the search-discovery team that unlocked a \$5M opportunity.
- Ran root-cause performance analysis to flag 125,000 underperforming SKUs (~25% of assortment), executed SKU rationalization against defined thresholds, and developed Rug Bundles to lift average order value and cross-sell.
- Audited returns and cancellation patterns using SQL, identified defaulting vendors, and recovered \$222K in return revenue with -3pps returns and cancellations rate, and used Adobe Analytics to run funnel and conversion analysis across top subcategories.
- Developed a custom GPT-powered tool to automate Weekly Business Review dashboards, translating raw CSV/Excel and SQL data into performance insights and narrative reporting for leadership.
- Partnered with content, technology, marketplace, and search-discovery teams, plus an in-house paid-media team across major marketing channels, to execute category initiatives end to end; mentored and onboarded new joiner Analysts on reporting practices and category execution.

Woriso

Bengaluru, India

Risk Analyst | July 2020 - March 2022

- Worked in an international consulting capacity, advising corporate clients in the IT, Oil, Aviation, and Banking & Finance sectors across MENA and Africa on political, security, and operational risk, and business continuity planning.
- Led a cross-functional team of 5 to build Threat Prism, converting manual, email-based risk updates and client reports into a self-serve dashboard mapping client risk exposure by geography and a severity-based threat matrix; regularly pitched the platform to prospective clients, supporting new business development. Mentored risk analysts and interns across the wider team.

PROJECTS

Assortment Strategy Deck

Analyzed regional buying patterns to identify assortment and selection gaps across categories, then built a data-driven strategy deck to close them for the upcoming buying year.

Customer Re-engagement (Email & Push Retargeting)

Spotted lapsed-customer re-engagement as an opportunity despite rising site traffic, curated a recurring Color of the Month / Style of the Month retargeting campaign, and generated \$149K in incremental revenue.

Bespoke Risk & Business Continuity Reports

Delivered travel security guidance, COVID-19 trend analysis, and country/city risk assessments supporting business continuity planning for corporate clients across MENA and Africa, covering major events including the Myanmar coup and coal shortages in India.

EDUCATION

MA International Studies, Symbiosis School of International Studies (2020), CGPA 7.72

BA (Hons) Political Science, Bhawanipur Education Society College (2018)

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Digital Marketing Fundamentals | Wharton Online: Customer Analytics | Udemmy: Social Media Marketing | Introduction to AI (Coursera)

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Adobe Analytics | Google Analytics | Google Trends | SimilarWeb | BazaarVoice | Meltwater | Medallia | SQL | Advanced Excel | Power BI | Looker | Looker Studio | ChatGPT / Custom GPT Development